

HR Strategy on a Page: Enable Enterprise AI Transformation

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Initiatives: Functional Design; Transform HR through AI; Shape Work for the Human-Machine Era; CxO Leadership; Strategy, Risks and Opportunities

CHROs support enterprise AI transformation with a business-aligned human capital strategy, but it's challenging to prioritize HR actions and address AI's talent implications. This one-page resource guides CHROs in crafting and communicating a strategy to enable enterprise AI transformation.

Insights at a Glance

This resource, part of Gartner's Strategy on a Page series, helps CHROs craft a contextualized, one-page strategy for HR to enable AI transformation of the enterprise. CHROs can use it to clearly communicate HR's strategy to C-suite partners and HR leaders in a simple visual format, guiding prioritization and informed action.

It identifies a set of human capital strategies that HR can follow to enable AI transformation of the enterprise, grouped across the following phases:

- Phase 1: Set Enterprise Foundations for AI
- Phase 2: Transform Work and Organization Design
- Phase 3: Equip the Workforce for AI Success
- Phase 4: Revamp Talent Processes

Recommendations for CHROs:

- Organize a cross-functional coalition, including peers such as the CIO and the CFO, to define AI ambition and strategic priorities if they do not exist already. Lead efforts to establish human-first AI principles.
- Transform work, roles and organization design to maximize AI impact and unlock efficiencies at scale.

- Accelerate workforce reskilling and drive AI adoption through change management and dedicated support for talent segments disrupted by AI.
- Reshape talent processes to reflect new expectations for AI-enabled work, performance and productivity.

Leverage the report below and its downloadable PowerPoint to develop an HR strategy on a page to enable AI enterprise transformation contextualized for your organization.

The Challenge of Creating an HR Strategy to Enable Enterprise AI Transformation

Organizations that underestimate the layered talent implications of enterprise AI initiatives position transformation efforts to fail before they even get started. AI's behavioral byproducts, ramifications for careers and required change management all put pressure on CHROs developing an HR strategy that supports the workforce and helps the organization make good on AI investments. It is incumbent upon CHROs to set clear priorities for HR to enable enterprise AI transformation, covering areas such as driving AI adoption, managing human-AI capabilities and fostering a culture of innovation.

Gartner offers this edition of the HR Strategy on a Page series to achieve these goals, providing CHROs with prioritized initiatives for a specific scenario — enable enterprise AI transformation (see Figure 1).

Figure 1: HR Strategy on a Page: Enable Enterprise AI Transformation

HR Strategy on a Page: Enable Enterprise AI Transformation

 **Strategic mission:** Your organization is embarking on enterprise AI transformation to improve productivity, drive growth and gain market share.



Source: Gartner
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[Download the full PowerPoint for more details](#)

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This report contains a set of human capital strategic initiatives that enable enterprise AI transformation. These initiatives are rarely sequential, as organizations often find themselves building them out simultaneously or in different orders. Still, they are grouped by phases in the report to situate them in the end-to-end transformation journey.

Actions

HR Strategy on a Page: Enable Enterprise AI Transformation

CHROs seeking to enable the enterprise for AI transformation should:

- Review this HR Strategy on a Page resource to understand the full transformation journey.
- Contextualize the actions for your organization's unique priorities.
- Mobilize your HR leadership team to take coordinated, cross-functional action.

Cautions

- Allowing automation of legacy workflows without considering redesign with more advanced AI capabilities, thus failing to capture potential business value.
- Failing to rethink skills and talent implications of AI adoption, generating negative effects by overestimating AI impact or underestimating behavioral impacts.
- Over- or underinvesting in the HR capabilities needed to enable enterprise AI transformation.

How to Execute

Scenario: Enable Enterprise AI Transformation

As CEOs lay out ambitious visions for an AI-enabled future, CHROs must create an HR strategy to enable the enterprise for AI transformation in alignment with overall enterprise goals. AI value only materializes when organizations redesign work, roles and structures and empower talent to find new ways to be productive. CHROs will succeed when they set clear priorities for HR as their HR leadership team grapples with AI-related initiatives, from change management and adoption to reskilling and governance. This resource defines the essential HR decisions to guide enterprise AI transformation.

The prioritization of the following human capital initiatives will depend on your starting point. We have grouped them in a set of phases that most organizations go through — calibrate them to your current point in the transformation journey, maturity, resources and overall goals. We have created a series of recommended stages of development that most organizations and HR teams tend to go through. However, each stage involves trial and error and rethinking and redesign, especially given the speed at which AI is progressing. These stages are not necessarily sequential, so organizations find themselves building these phases out at different points in time or even in parallel.

Phase 1: Set Enterprise Foundations for AI

Translate AI Goals Into Coordinated Action

If it doesn't exist already, align a cross-functional AI steering committee to create a set of principles, priorities and protocols related to AI transformation and the questions that emerge from it. This team should have signoff authority on all AI-related topics (risks, initiatives, training, communications, etc.) and regularly monitor market trends, employee feedback and initiative results to drive continuous improvement. CHROs may not drive or select the leaders to participate in these types of committees, but they should establish HR as a consistent voice in a holistic AI enterprise governance.

One of the CHROs' responsibilities in this forum is to set human-first AI principles and concrete governance to reinforce them. CHROs should lead efforts to align the executive team on consistent, human-first messaging to prevent role confusion, trust erosion and adoption stalls. For guidance on crafting communication governance, see [How We Talk About AI at Work Matters](#).

Additionally, in partnership with this cross-functional group, CHROs can also co-lead consistent measurement of AI initiatives to measure the success of investments and align with workforce priorities. Facilitate a set of strategy sessions to clarify the organization's principles around risk appetite, desired outcomes and success measures with ROI thresholds. These metrics should be standard across the organization to evaluate use cases, prioritize pilots and measure impact with a common language. For support in establishing AI metrics, see [12 AI Value Metrics for CHROs to Drive Enterprise Transformation](#).

Assess AI Maturity and Readiness

While others, such as the CIO, will handle tasks such as mapping AI use across the organization and communicating AI roadmaps, CHROs can add value to strategic planning by aligning AI maturity and ambitions with workforce readiness. Use Gartner's [AI Maturity Assessment](#) as a benchmarking resource. While the CIO or chief AI leader (CAIL) will own technical sections in the assessment, CHROs will own aspects related to people and culture and must drive these efforts proactively. Debrief results with your steering committee to surface AI pain points and opportunities, and prioritize actions accordingly. When evaluating AI use cases, consider change readiness across business units most impacted by AI and remember HR's mandate to champion employee voice.

Ultimately, CHROs will aim to develop a clear picture of AI maturity and readiness across the organization so that they can plan HR resource deployment accordingly. By identifying high-impact areas with low AI readiness, CHROs can more proactively close capability gaps and build an AI-ready workforce. For guidance on crafting an overarching AI people strategy to achieve these goals, see [Every Enterprise Needs an AI People Strategy: Here's How CHROs Can Build One](#).

Phase 2: Transform Work and Organization Design

Mobilize HR to Help Transform Work Itself

Work transformation is a shared responsibility, and organizations must make meaningful, coordinated changes to how work gets done in order to capture AI value. HR can play a critical role in this cross-functional effort by identifying operating model and capability needs. For more details on how HR can help, see [Redesign Work to Achieve AI Value](#).

One critical area for HR contribution is in identifying AI transformation opportunities across the business. Use process mapping and job analysis to pinpoint tasks and workflows that can be augmented, reengineered, or fully automated with AI (see [Transforming How Work Gets Done: 2025 HR Symposium/Xpo Keynote Highlights](#)). Conduct focus groups with employees to identify friction points in critical processes. Create feedback mechanisms between employee voice and AI strategy to ensure bottom-up AI use cases don't get lost in translation. HR can support business leaders by sourcing and sharing this insight from employees.

The transformation of work necessitates disruptive change for employees. As AI's talent implications continue to evolve, CHROs should create a dynamic, repeatable approach to managing them — see [How to Redesign Work in the Human-Machine Era](#). Iteratively evolve role profiles, competency expectations, and performance metrics to reflect shifting accountabilities and emerging skills. Where applicable, pilot new approaches and collect feedback to inform future initiatives. For further guidance on evolving jobs to reflect new AI expectations, see [CHRO's Guide to Designing Enterprise Jobs for the AI Era](#).

Rethink Organization Design to Unlock Value and Scale Efficiencies

CHROs will also need to implement critical shifts in their organization design to unlock the transformational potential of AI at scale. Be clear about how and why you use AI in your organization design — decide intentionally where AI should be embedded and where it should not. Keep decisions tied to the intended outcome to prevent drift from the original AI ambition. See [How AI Will Change Your Organization Design](#) for more details.

A critical imperative for CHROs will be to reflect updated workflows, reporting lines, team structures and new ways of working in organization design strategies. Create pathways to accelerate fusion team collaboration, and align decision rights and accountabilities as teams get leaner and flatter with AI. While AI accelerates organization design needs and expectations, the core tenets of HR's approach remain consistent. See [Playbook: 7 Hallmarks for Intentional Organization Design](#) for resources on driving enterprisewide transformation.

Phase 3: Equip the Workforce for AI Success

Drive AI Adoption

CHROs are held accountable for developing the workforce AI literacy required for effective and sustainable adoption. By removing barriers to adoption, addressing employees' skills and motivation needs and simplifying access to meaningful AI tools in the flow of work, CHROs can set the foundation for responsible AI use across the organization. For more details, see [Path to AI Adoption and ROI: CHRO Strategies to Accelerate AI Literacy Programs](#).

To drive increases in productivity, promote learning and experimentation that surface AI use cases at the role level. AI literacy training will have limited impact if that training does not connect new AI tools to daily tasks. CHROs should guide learning and development (L&D) teams to connect AI learning to employees' real work problems, supporting everyday adoption. See [Evolve Employee Learning Activities to Drive AI Adoption](#) for guidance on building upon HR's traditional L&D methods for AI success.

Intentionally fostering a culture of innovation is critical for CHROs to drive AI adoption. As AI permeates the organizations, CHROs without an intentional approach to culture risk letting the organization's AI strategy define their culture. For resources on adapting culture to new business needs, see [2026 CHRO Priority: Strengthen Culture to Power Performance](#).

Accelerate Reskilling and Manage Associated Change

HR must help employees keep pace with AI's varied and evolving skills requirements. Tried-and-true methods may not apply, as AI breaks long-held assumptions about careers (see [AI Is Breaking Careers: Reset Your Approach to Internal Talent Advancement](#)). Specifically, one-size-fits-all approaches are unlikely to work as AI disrupts the employee experience unevenly.

CHROs should prioritize accordingly, targeting outsized support to employees most disrupted by AI. See [Case Study: Human-Centric Generative AI Strategy](#) (Vizient) for a sample, comprehensive approach to redesigning roles based on AI's impact. Develop role-based learning pathways that focus on upskilling the workforce on critical skills such as responsible AI use, data privacy and human-AI judgment. Tie learning to live AI use cases where possible, making it easier for employees to clearly identify how they stand to benefit from AI adoption.

Invest heavily in comprehensive change management, including communication guidance for leaders and managers, to combat AI skepticism. See [Case Study: AI Adoption and Change Management Support for People Managers](#) for details on how Lenovo positioned middle managers as force multipliers of AI change through resources like empathy maps, guiding principles and regular feedback loops.

Phase 4: Revamp Talent Processes

Shift Behaviors Through Talent Management

As AI becomes embedded in daily work, CHROs must ensure that core talent management processes actively reinforce, not undermine, desired AI-enabled behaviors. CHROs should recalibrate performance management to reflect AI-enabled ways of working. This includes updating performance standards, providing managers with guidance on new methods and establishing goal-setting practices that incentivize outcomes and learning, not the proliferation of low-quality AI-supported work. For more details, see [Adapting Performance Management for Employees Leveraging AI](#).

Additionally, CHROs should aim to recognize and reward high-performing employees in the age of AI. It is important to recognize employees who use AI to enhance their personal performance or find productivity gains for the organization. See [Adapt Pay for Performance for the Age of AI](#) for insight on accounting for AI's impact on pay-for-performance strategies and incentivizing performance amid AI disruption.

Modernize Strategic Workforce Planning

Strategic workforce planning is a notoriously difficult activity, but AI's complex and unknown ripple effects make it even harder than before. Redesigning work for AI creates ripple effects, or second- and third-order consequences, for HR to manage (see [Top Talent Risks of Redesigning Work for AI](#)). These effects, such as shrinking entry-level talent pipelines or negative well-being impacts from AI use, may be outside the organization's direct control.

As AI fundamentally changes both demand (what work needs to be done) and supply (how that work is delivered) for organizations, CHROs should modernize strategic workforce planning by explicitly incorporating realistic AI assumptions. By accounting for factors such as augmentation versus automation, adoption timelines and variation across business units, CHROs can better plan for hiring, redeployment and reskilling across the organization. See [Strategic Workforce Planning: 4 Shifts in the Era of Work Disruption](#) for guidance on moving beyond legacy strategic workforce planning in response to AI disruption.

Continuously Assess Human Capital Risk

AI transformation introduces new and evolving human capital risks that cannot be managed through one-time assessments. Ethical concerns, skills atrophy, regulatory change and trust erosion can all surface gradually or immediately.

CHROs should operationalize an ongoing human capital risk assessment, embedded into existing governance and steering committee processes. This includes building live feedback loops that capture lessons learned from pilots, employee sentiment, manager capability gaps, and compliance or ethics concerns. Regularly revisit KPIs and risk indicators with cross-functional leaders to course-correct early. Review Gartner's 2026 CHRO Emerging Risk Report for insight on emerging enterprise risks that could deter the CHROs' ability to sustain work design, culture, growth, and AI transformation ([4 Emerging Risks CHROs Should Address in 2026](#)).

Success Measures

To measure the success of enterprise AI transformation enablement, CHROs can refer to a few suggested KPIs below; a more comprehensive list is provided in the attached PowerPoint presentation.

- AI-enabled labor cost savings
- AI literacy rate
- AI spend per FTE
- Managers trained to support employees using AI
- Employee AI attitudes

Recommended by the Authors

Some documents may not be available as part of your current Gartner subscription.

[Toolkit: Plan for AI's Impact on Jobs](#)

[AI-Job-Impact-Scoring Tools: Why They Fall Short and What to Do Instead](#)

[Plan for Generative AI's Impact on Jobs](#)

[Adapting Workforce Strategies to Prepare for AI's Impact on Jobs](#)

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